

CANDY DIALOGUE ENGINE

Portraits

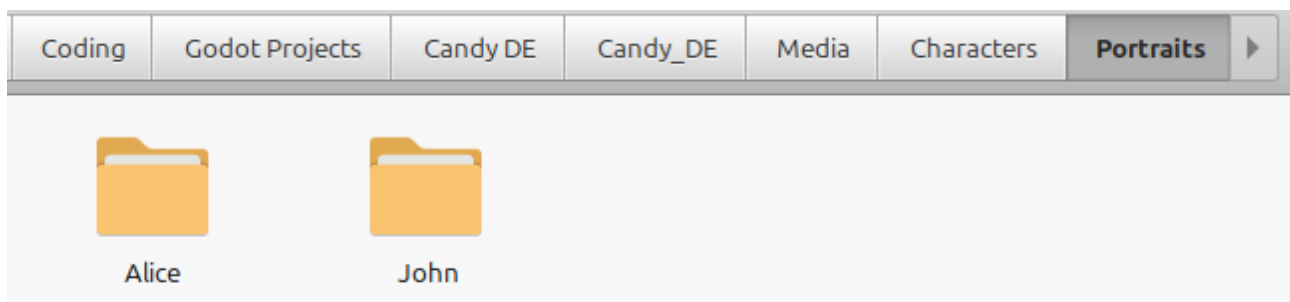
1.0.1

Portraits are displayed by the "Box" dialogue mode and show an image of the speaking character.

Folder Structure

Before you can assign portraits to lines, you'll need to organize your portrait files correctly inside the resources folders.

Assuming you're using the default folder setup, open **Candy_DE/Media/Characters/Portraits**:



In the **Portraits** folder, you must create a subfolder for every actor, where you will place portrait files for the corresponding actor. The actor's folder name must match the actor's reference in the **actors** dictionary, in **Candy_Database.gd**.

Animated Folders

**Note: Animated Folders only work with TextureRect and NinePatchRect nodes.
TextureButton nodes are not supported at this time.**

You have the option of creating animated portraits from multiple image files, which act as frames for the animation. To do this, follow these steps:

1. Inside an actor's folder, create a folder called "Animated".
2. In the Animated folder, create a folder for each animation. Give these folders any name you want.
3. Place the image files for each animation inside its corresponding folder.

4. The files will be displayed in alphabetical order, so name them appropriately (e.g. Smiling_001, Smiling_002, etc.).

Make sure to use zero-padding for numbers: this means writing '001' instead of just '1'. Otherwise, '10' will come before '2' or '9' in alphabetical order.

Be careful with animation folder names that match standalone image or video files: when you provide a file name without an extension to a command (e.g. "Smile" instead of "Smile .png"), Candy DE checks if an animation folder of that name exists. If so, it uses that animation.

If no animation folder of the same name exists, Candy DE checks if a file of the same name, with the default extension, exists (e.g. "Smile .png" if .png is set as the default).

In other words, if you have an animation folder named "Smile", you can't provide "Smile" as a substitute for "Smile .png": Candy DE will use the "Smile" animation.

Optionally, in each animation folder, you can create a txt file named 'config.txt'. In that file, add this line:

fps = 2.0

This tells the dialogue engine the speed to play each animation at, in frames per second. For example, a value of 5 means that 5 images will be displayed per second.

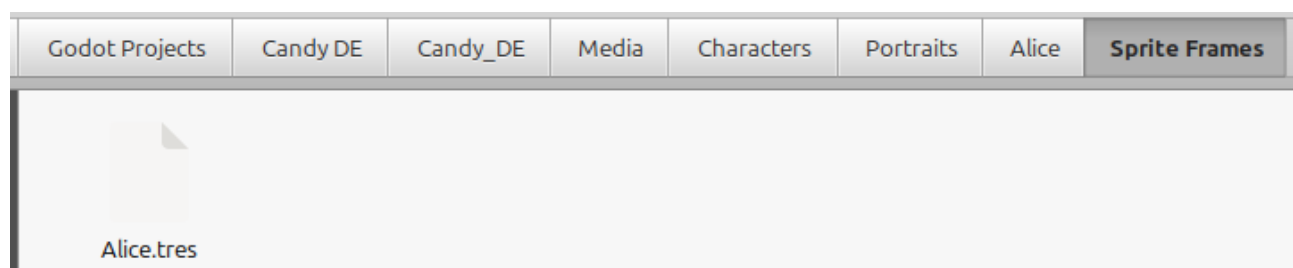
You can replace the fps value with any number you want, including decimal numbers.

If an animation doesn't have a config.txt file, the engine will use the default **image_fps** value of the portrait box (this is an exported variable in the **Portraits.gd** script; you can modify it in the inspector, in the portrait box scene: **Candy_DE/Scenes/Portrait Areas/Default.tscn**).

To make display an animation as a portrait, just provide the name of the animation's folder as the portrait file (e.g. "Smile").

AnimatedSprite2D/3D

If the portrait display node is an AnimatedSprite2D or AnimatedSprite3D, a subfolder named "Sprite Frames" must be created inside the actor's portrait folder. A SpriteFrames resource (.tres) must be saved in the folder, and named the same as the actor's reference.



TextureButton

TextureButton nodes can accept multiple textures, in addition to texture_normal: texture_pressed, texture_hover, etc. Candy DE is designed to handle this automatically if you have corresponding files:

If the portrait display node is a TextureButton, a subfolder named "Button Textures" can be created inside the actor's portrait folder. Inside that folder, you can create a subfolder for each normal texture file: name these subfolders exactly as the normal texture file they match to. Use underscore (_) instead of a coma (,) to separate the file extension in the subfolder name.

For example, if the file you plan to assign to texture_normal is named "Happy.png", name the subfolder "Happy_png".

In each subfolder, you can add files for the various texture types that TextureButton nodes support: texture_pressed, texture_hover, texture_disabled, texture_focused and texture_click_mask.

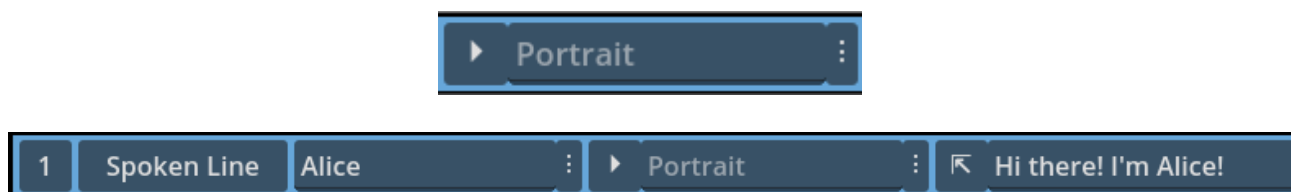
Name these files anything you like, but add the texture type as a prefix. For example: "texture_pressed.png" or "Happy_texture_pressed.png" will both work.

Candy DE will automatically assign the files to the TextureButton node if they exist (having files for all texture types is not required).

To be clear: the file for texture_normal must be placed in the actor's folder (e.g. [Candy_DE/Media/Characters/Portraits/Alice](#)). It does not need the texture_normal suffix in its name (e.g. "Happy.png" is fine). This allows you to re-use the same file for other node types.

Assigning Portraits

Portraits can be assigned in the "Portrait" field of a Spoken Line:



You can type the name of the file, but if you've setup your portrait files and folders correctly, if you've provided a speaker reference for the line, and if you've provided the Candy Dialogue Creator with the path to your project, you can make things even easier:

Just click the (:) button next to the Portrait field, and a list of all portrait files matching the speaker will appear. Just click to select the right one.

And if you're not sure which portrait file is the one you're looking for, just hover any file in the list to preview it!

If the Portrait field is left empty, Candy DE will use the file named "Default" if it exists. This saves you from having to provide a file name each time you want to display the default portrait for a speaker.

If you don't want a line to display a portrait, toggle the ☺ button. The button's colors mean the following:

- **Green:** always show a portrait for the line (used if you want to display a portrait in addition to a VN bust for the speaker).
- **Red:** never show a portrait for the line.
- **White:** no special rules.

And as an extra convenience, you don't need to write the file's extension (e.g. .png or .jpg) as long as the Portrait box is configured to use the same extension as the default for portrait files.

Default extensions are configured in **Portrait.gd** through the **default_..._extension** variables:

```
@export var default_image_extension = ".png"
@export var default_sprite_extension = ".png"
@export var default_animated_sprite_extension = ".tres"
@export var default_video_extension = ".ogv"
```

These variables allow you to use different default extensions depending on the type of node that displays portraits.

Animated Portraits

Candy DE supports animated portraits in multiple formats. This requires that the portrait display node be a Sprite2D/3D, AnimatedSprite2D/3D, or VideoStreamPlayer.

As normal, in the Portrait field of the Spoken Line, provide the name of the file you want to play. if the portrait display node is an AnimatedSprite2D/3D, provide the name of the animation you want to play. The Sprite Files resource will be loaded automatically, provided it is located in the correct folder and named correctly.

Next to the Portrait field, toggle the 'play' button to indicate whether you want the animation to play when the line is processed. If 'play' is disabled, the animation will pause on the first frame. In the Candy Dialogue Creator, 'play' is always enabled by default.

For Sprite2D/3D and AnimatedSprite2D/3D nodes, you'll want to configure the **sprite_fps** variable in **Portrait.gd**: set it to the number of frames-per-second you want the animation to play at.

Actor Rules

You can assign each actor special rules about portrait display.

In the **actors** dictionary, in **Candy_Database.gd**, change the value of any actor's **"Portrait"** key:

-1 → Never show a portrait for this actor.

- 1** → Always show a portrait for this actor.
- 0** → No special rules.

Note that the ☺ button of Spoken Lines overrides these actor rules.

Portrait Mode

The **portrait_mode** variable in **Candy_Engine.gd** allows you to select a portrait mode. It can accept the following values:

"Off" → A portrait is never shown for any actors.

"Player" → A portrait is only shown if the speaker's actor reference is found in the **player_refs** array in **Candy_Database.gd**. This option can be used so that only the player's character (or playable characters) display a portrait.

"NPC" → This is the opposite of "Player": a portrait is only shown if the speaker's actor reference is **not** found in the **player_refs** array.

"VN" → Portraits are shown only if the speaker does not have a VN bust assigned, and if **vn_mode** (**Candy_Engine.gd**) is set to 'true'.

"All" → Portraits are shown for all actors.

These settings are overridden by actor rules and by the ☺ button of Spoken Lines.